



For professional investors only | markets 2026-08-05/06 mixed · claims week ending 2026-08-01 · inflation June 2026 | As-of 2026-08-08 · Saturday (the 1 August slot was not rendered — see below) | Reading time ≈ 4 minutes | Publisher: KRINO — published by A.G.

The measured panel reached its softest reading of this window on every axis at once. Four surfaces the panel does not measure moved the other way in the same week.

Stress CALM · **Inflation** WATCH · **Evidence strength** Low · inflation regime WATCH since 2026-03 — fifth live reading; June print unchanged

THE RECORD — regime history



Every measured part of the panel is at or near its calmest level of this observation window, and credit is the calmest part of it. The market-stress index reads -0.716 standard deviations, the 21.6th percentile of 2018-onward history and a fourth consecutive easing; equity volatility is 15.81; the high-yield credit gap is 1.10 against a 1.44 reference and the high-yield spread itself sits at 2.75 percent, its 15.4th percentile; the yield curve is $+0.44$ and not inverted; none of three leading indicators is flashing. Four surfaces the panel does not measure moved the other way across the same days. The equity index recorded a 252-session high of 7,736.52 on 4 August and then closed lower on both following sessions, to 7,709.96 on 6 August, so the high stands and was not extended. The tail-risk index retraced roughly three fifths of the collapse recorded last week, to 134.73. Initial jobless claims printed 199,000 for the week ending 1 August, a third consecutive weekly rise from 189,000, with the prior week revised from 197,000 to 198,000. Foreign official custody holdings of United States Treasuries fell 25.5 billion dollars in the week to 5 August, to 2,631.1 billion, after three consecutive issues recorded that series rising. This is the first week in this observation window in which the unmeasured surfaces and the measured panel point different ways. The panel governs the published state; the divergence is recorded rather than resolved. Between scheduled releases the published state moves only on the pre-registered falsifiers below — headlines and commentary, including this report's own, change nothing by themselves.

Strongest observation against this reading

Required section, fourth and final week of the trial. (1) The strongest single observation against this report's reading is that the measured panel reached its softest level of the window on every axis simultaneously, and credit — the highest-quality signal family here — reached its tightest level of the window while the equity index sat within half a per cent of a record high. (2) It most benefits the reading that the underlying situation is not deteriorating and that this report's framework has been over-reading a benign environment. (3) The interpretation is retained for three stated reasons, each able to fail: the reported chokepoint arrangement is unsigned and its predecessor did not conclude; a transit fee of the reported size is a durable cost change rather than a temporary condition; and the four unmeasured surfaces named above moved against the panel in the same week. IDENTITY MISMATCH: YES — the observation named in (1) would give a competing reading more net support this period than the leading interpretation receives. Disclosed as a flag for the reader. It is not an automatic correction and it does not change the published state.

WHAT WOULD PROVE THIS WRONG

- ☐ Jobless claims sustained above 300,000
- ☐ Yield curve back below zero
- ☐ High-yield credit through its divergence tripwire
- ☐ Sixth straight month of consumer inflation at or above 4% year-over-year

Hash-committed before publication · verify github.com/foxtrot76/krino-commitments

The thesis

Active reading (≈70%)

A negotiated arrangement over the Strait of Hormuz is reported to be near, and its terms changed materially inside one week. On 5 August the reported terms included no transit fees. On 7 August the principal unresolved term was reported as a transit fee of 5 to 7 per cent of cargo value sought by Iran, against approximately 3 per cent proposed by Oman. The arrangement is unsigned. Both reports are on this project's record and neither has replaced the other; the contradiction is published rather than reconciled. A standing charge on cargo value at a chokepoint is a durable change in the cost of transit — a different object from a temporary closure, which resolves when the closure ends. That is the mechanism one of the competing explanations scored here names explicitly, and that explanation had been marked down the preceding week on price evidence. Confidence: PLAUSIBLE — the arrangement is unsigned, the fee figures are attributed to unnamed sources, and a prior arrangement was reported as near-final three weeks earlier and did not conclude.

Strongest opposing case (≈20%)

The strongest opposing case is that the panel is simply right and this issue is manufacturing significance out of four unrelated weekly movements. Custody holdings, jobless claims, an unextended index high and a retraced volatility index are noisy series, and any given week will produce four of them pointing somewhere. No statistical test here establishes that the co-movement is other than coincidence, and none is claimed.

Rejected alternatives (≈10%)

Alternative	Rejected because
Nothing is happening; premiums revert and the panel is correct throughout	A reported transfer of chokepoint control, and a fee of the reported size, are not consistent with an unchanged environment. Live.
Measured transit collapse overstates actual flow	The market body attributes reduced traffic to vessel-safety decisions — real vessels, not a measurement artefact. Live.
Price calm rests on an unexamined spare-capacity belief	An explicitly priced chokepoint is the opposite of an unexamined belief. Weakened this period.

The evidence

Signal	Reading	Threshold	Status
Equity volatility (VIX)	15.81	< 20	calm (08-05)
S&P 500	7,709.96	—	08-06; the 08-04 high of 7,736.52 stands, unextended
Yield curve (10y – 2y)	+0.44	> 0	positive, not inverted (08-06)
High-yield credit gap	1.10 divergence	< 1.44	benign; HY 2.75%, 15.4th pctl (08-05)
Initial jobless claims	199,000	< 300k	third weekly rise (wk to 08-01)
Market-stress index	−0.716 sd · 21.6th pctl	90th = elevated	fourth easing; equals window low (08-05)

On repeated readings. The panel is re-read each week, but its signals track slow-moving conditions. A reading that persists across several issues is therefore largely the same observation restated, not a series of independent confirmations — and a longer streak is not stronger evidence. Where this issue cites a run of consecutive readings, read it as duration, not as accumulation.

Inflation-regime axis

Component	Value	Threshold	Fires
Consumer inflation, year-over-year	3.53%	≥ 3%	yes
Consumer inflation, 3-month annualised	4.61%	≥ year-over-year rate	yes
Months ≥ 4% year-over-year	1 of 6	6 to arm	no
Real policy rate	≈ +0.1%	≤ −1.0%	no
Real-equity erosion	—	depressed	no

Method

Coverage map — maturation: **Observed** → **Monitored** → **Instrumented** → **Scored**

Coverage area	Stage
Market stress — vol, credit, liquidity	Scored
Inflation regime	Scored (live)
Labour slack	Scored
Commodity / energy shocks	Monitored
Private credit	Watch
Geopolitics / chokepoints	Observed

Named blindspots

Coverage first, measured rather than asserted. Forty-one data series are collected on each refresh. Of the readings this issue publishes, 41 of 41 numbers were verified against their source files by an automated check before publication, with zero mismatches — up from 33 at the previous issue. That check compares a published figure to the file it was derived from; it does not certify figures this project computes from those inputs. **FOUR BLINDSPOTS**, stated plainly. **FIRST**, and it is the largest remaining gap: quantities this project derives — drawdown depths, standardised scores, composite readings — are NOT verified against any external source. Named here rather than described as covered. **SECOND**, chokepoint transit counts are not collected on a fixed schedule; where this issue refers to transit volumes it relies on third-party reports with their own coverage limits. **THIRD**, monthly employment data is not collected by this pipeline at all, and one live forward test depends on it, so that test passed its gate date this week and could not be graded. The gap is stated rather than left implied, and no source has yet been established. **FOURTH**, the publication slot of 1 August was not rendered; the break is recorded rather than absorbed, this issue is numbered 005, and no issue has been renumbered or backdated. Standing limitations unchanged: energy supply shocks are monitored but not scored; private-credit stress is not visible in public spreads and is watched, not scored.

Live forward tests

Labour-slack sign — reg. 2026-06-23; gate date 2026-08-07 passed — NOT GRADED: the monthly employment series is not collected by this pipeline (blocked)

Inflation-regime transition — live; next test: the August print, when the three-month window rolls (monthly)

Haven inversion — reg. 2026-06-18; grades on the next genuine risk-off episode (event-driven)

Governance

Layer status

Validated (shown as validated): market-stress axis; inflation-regime axis. Provisional — under evaluation: the multi-thesis interpretation layer (dual-read shown for transparency; promoted only when its validator is operational and the evaluation phase clears).

Independent review — red-team, not user/subscriber feedback

No external round this period — the last completed red-team round closed 2026-07-29. Main concern: no outside review was run on this issue's analytical content. A governance rule adopted this week is marked, by this project's own trigger list, as requiring a review round before it takes effect; that round has not been held. The rule is labelled provisional and is not enforced as a gate. Disclosed here rather than reported at a later date

Correction carried this period — an evidence item entered last week on a single day's movement in a tail-risk index. Main concern: the index retraced roughly three fifths of that movement within two sessions and the item was re-graded. The convention requiring more than one observation had been applied to a competing explanation and not to this project's own entry. The correction is visible in the record

Published state never moves on review count. Challenges are logged; the state changes only on a pre-registered falsifier. Resolved this period: a pre-registered adjudication that had been reported as blocked by a nine-day data outage was found to be blocked by a posting lag instead — the series resumed and backfilled five observations, the adjudication was run, and its price criterion was met while its transit criterion could not be verified from any source this project collects. The disposition is held rather than declared. A rule was adopted requiring that any claim that something is unobservable or unavailable carry a revalidation date and a named re-test.

Submit a challenge (classified under the challenge-intake taxonomy): krino.reviews@gmail.com

Appendix A — Audit

For verification. Durable technical record; optional for ordinary readers.

Locks & provenance

Item	Value
Understanding-model lock	v15 8d4515ed
Thesis ontology (frozen)	v1.0 ff5466c3
Frozen fixtures	v2 68e56f0a
Data bundle for this issue	pulled 2026-08-07 13:54–13:55 CEST, read from the archive's internal timestamps
Source verification	41 of 41 published numbers matched to source, 0 mismatches
Commitment log	github.com/foxtrot76/krino-commitments

Open challenges

ID	Challenge	Opened	Status	Severity
CH-010	Forward tests are weaker than the hypothesis machinery that feeds them	2026-08-02	Open — raised by an outside reviewer	High
CH-009	Project may be over-inspecting its own tools while the forecast clock stands still	2026-07-25	Open in part — remedy deferred to the October review	High
CH-003	Rules written to address attention decay may themselves fail under load	2026-07-20	Open — discriminating probe pre-registered for 1 October	Med
CH-001	Live inflation axis unvalidated (n=1)	2026-07-06	Open — its adjudicating print is blocked; see Method	Med
+1 more	CH-002 — see the challenge log	—	Logged	—

Strongest outstanding challenge

That the panel is simply right and this issue is manufacturing significance from four unrelated weekly movements. It is the same charge stated on page 2 as the opposing case, and it is repeated here because it is also the strongest challenge to the report as a whole this period rather than to one section of it: this report has a stronger mechanism for generating and comparing explanations than for proving that its forward tests can genuinely fail. Two of the three live tests are blocked or event-driven, and the third grades monthly. Open — remedy outstanding.

GLOSSARY

Divergence tripwire

The high-yield vs BB spread gap that would signal credit stress (1.44).

Drawdown

The fall from a recent peak, expressed as a percentage.

Falsifier

A pre-registered condition that, if met, moves the published state.

Percentile

Where a reading sits within its own history; the 20th percentile means 80% of past readings were higher.

Standard deviation

A measure of how far a reading sits from its own average.

Method: KRINO classifies macro regimes from public data under a fixed protocol — hypotheses and their falsifiers are hash-stamped before evaluation; thresholds frozen before validation; instruments adopted only after out-of-sample validation and independent review; every revision and defect logged.

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